SC03 | Student Performance & Academic Intervention System

Difficulty: Advanced capstone **Core techniques:** Perceptron + ADALINE + Backpropagation **Team:** 3-4 students

1. What you are building

Create a working decision-support product that converts **attendance, marks, assignments and engagement** into **academic-risk category and intervention**. The final system must be runnable by a user, explain its result visually, and demonstrate why Soft Computing is more suitable than a rigid rule-only approach.

2. Why this is a Soft Computing capstone

• The problem contains uncertainty, non-linear behaviour, competing goals, or incomplete information.

• You must expose the important algorithmic elements rather than only calling a library function.

• A baseline is compulsory: majority class or score threshold. Your evidence must show what the Soft Computing solution improves.

3. Product and system architecture

Pipeline: data/scenario collection → validation and preprocessing → baseline → Perceptron + ADALINE + Backpropagation model → decision/optimised output → evaluation dashboard.

The application may use Streamlit, a clear notebook interface, GUI, or command-line interface with meaningful visualisation. It must accept inputs, run the method, return a result, and show at least one explanation, plot, table, schedule, route, or membership/fitness view.

4. Data and experimental strategy

Required source: cited 10,000+ student records or documented augmentation. Document dataset name, URL, licence, original size, features/targets, all preprocessing, and any scenario-generation assumptions. The minimum is 10,000 records or realistic test scenarios. Do not invent a citation: state clearly what is real and what is simulated.

5. Milestone 1 - Working Product V1

Implement preprocessing, one transparent classifier, baseline and a risk/intervention dashboard.

M1 deliverables and acceptance test:

• Repository created early, with README, requirements, source/app folders, data citation, and continuous commits.

• At least 10,000 records/scenarios documented and a reproducible preprocessing or generation step.

• One core Soft Computing algorithm working, plus the stated baseline.

• A user can demonstrate input → algorithmic processing → output. Documentation-only work is not accepted.

• At least two initial visuals: for example loss/error curve, membership plot, fitness curve, route/schedule, predicted-vs-actual, or baseline comparison.

• Interim report: problem, data, architecture, implementation, MVP screenshots, initial results, limitations and next steps.

6. Milestone 2 - Enhanced Product V2

Compare Perceptron, ADALINE and BPN; tune learning settings; analyse imbalance, noise, fairness and errors.

M2 deliverables and acceptance test:

• Complete the advanced/hybrid component and make the final application cleanly runnable from README instructions.

• Run parameter experiments rather than a single best run. Explain settings, results, and decisions.

• Compare baseline, M1 approach, and advanced M2 approach where applicable, using F1, recall, confusion matrix and loss.

• Deliberately test edge cases: noise, extreme values, contradictory inputs, unseen cases, or difficult constraints.

• Publish final plots/tables, report, ~5-minute demo video, presentation material, and team contribution details.

7. Required repository evidence

• README with team, problem, architecture, dataset citation, setup/run commands, results and limitations.

• src/ for reusable algorithms; app/ for runnable product; results/ for labelled outputs; report/ for reports; data/README.md for source information.

• Meaningful commits throughout the semester, such as “Implement fuzzy rules”, “Add GA mutation”, or “Evaluate baseline”. A final ZIP/code dump does not earn full Git marks.

8. Evaluation evidence (50 marks)

GitHub - 10 marks Structure, code quality, meaningful commits, and visible contribution.	**Report - 10 marks** Problem, data citation, methodology, implementation, experiments, and results.
Video - 10 marks Problem, concept explanation, product demo, comparison, and clarity.	**Viva & Presentation - 20 marks** Technique understanding, own code, results, technical answers, and coordination.

Final reminder

This is an engineering product capstone. A strong submission makes it easy for a faculty member to run the project, inspect the evidence, compare it with the baseline, and ask each student about the part they built.